THE WEAKLY

A WEEKLY NONSENSE

Tuesday, 15th April 2025

Issue No. 16

Read this. *Excerpt from the journals of Plath*

MEDIA OF THE WEEK *In Defense of Rob from* High Fidelity

Weakly Word

I Love My Friends

JUKEBOX THE 90S JILTED LOVER

LIKED THE *WEAKLY?*

This zine needs YOU to keep it running, by sending in your musings, from your notes app to the backs of your books.

It is printed every first working day of the week- and distributed amongst whoever the editor runs into first. It's special in a way where you know that someone probably carries your poem in their wallet.

You can also find the Weakly *and more zines at* **DelhiZine**, *a zine collective devoted to sponsoring art. Catch us at* **@delhizine** *and* **delhizine.github.io**.

E-mail your thoughts, notes, pictures, sketches, sighing and crying to **tillstickk@gmail.com**. *Or maybe bump into me in the corridor. God knows, I love that.*

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Weakly Word

i love my friends so much | what is friendship really? | time and time again i've tried to measure it on account of actions, things said, things unsaid, gifts, efforts, texts, response time, the list goes on. unfortunately. | but time and time again i've realised, there really is no one fixed way, one fixed measure of friendship, of how close you are to someone | you can't put friends on different levels of a pyramid, shaping up a hierarchy from stranger to bff | that's just not how it works | maybe friendship is just staying on call when your friend knows you need someone, maybe friendship is just holding your hand and not letting go when you're so shit scared that you're squeezing it to hell, maybe friendship is just walking with you while you rant about one thing for the 67th time, maybe friendship is just telling you that one thing that "you can't tell to anyone", maybe friendship is just sitting with you when you're on the verge of a breakdown, offering you the comfort of their presence, maybe it's just making you feel seen, and if not, then just listening, trying to understand, trying to be there. | perhaps friendship is not something you can measure, but something that makes you feel warm. what makes you smile and laugh when you were about to cry five minutes ago. what keeps you from falling into the abyss of hopelessness, loneliness, and sadness. | i love my friends, and i am so very thankful and grateful to have them. i hope they know.

Read this.

And yet does it not all come again to the fact that it is a man's world? For if a man chooses to be promiscuous, he may still aesthetically turn up his nose at promiscuity. He may still demand a woman be faithful to him, to save him from his own lust. But women have lust, too. Why should they be relegated to the position of custodian of emotions, watcher of the infants, feeder of soul, body and pride of man? Being born a woman is my awful tragedy. From the moment I was conceived I was doomed to sprout breasts and ovaries rather than penis and scrotum; to have my whole circle of action, thought and feeling rigidly circumscribed by my inescapable femininity. Yes, my consuming desire to mingle with road crews, sailors and soldiers, bar room regulars - to be a part of scene, anonomous, listening, recording - all is spoiled by the fact that I am a girl, a female always in danger of assault and battery. My consuming interest in men and their lives is often misconstrued as a desire to seduce them, or as an invitation to intimacy. Yet, God, I want to talk to everybody I can as deeply as I can. I want to be able to sleep in an open field, to travel west, to walk freely at night ...

from The Unabridged Journals of Sylvia Plath, *Diary entry no. 93, 1951*

-a street in Varanasi, current home of the statue

MEDIA OF THE WEEK

This piece is solely a rage fuelled (or simply petty) response to Letterboxd and Storygraph reviews of Nick Hornby's book *High Fidelity* later turned into a movie of equal fibre. Now, look. I will keep my personal issues out of it by stating them here. I like it because I too, like Rob arrange intimate things in life in impersonal lists and cope by ducking in a corner and chanting lists of album titles. Like Rob, my top dream jobs are also writer for *Rolling Stone* and to own a record store. I make bad playlists for people then get wildly offended when they dont immediately fall in love with me and how seen I feel when Hornby writes: *I agreed that what really matters is what you like, not what you are like... Books, records, films - these things matter. Call me shallow but it's the fuckin' truth.* Now that we're past how deeply personal my attachment is for this and how badly I handly criticism and opinions unlike mine, lets come to its fair and just defense. Mainly the lead Rob's defense. He is, for the lack of a better word, and in the spirit of increased crass-ness of the *Weekly*, an asshole. A certified A-grade asshole. He judges people based on their music taste, wonders why his girlfriends leave him after being sore and insecure all the time, is a commitment-phobic, fickle, lazy man and he is also you and he is also me. Rob isnt the upstanding guy and the media make it VERY clear. Nobody is sympathising with Rob, much less romaticising him. Rob speaks a lot and understands himself less. Rob makes mistakes, then makes mixtapes, then makes apologies. Rob forgets to call his mom. And so do I, and so do you. Its OK. Not all your heroes wear capes; some wear a pretentious *The Pixies* shirt you will never find.

marriage, and now looks after us. These two mothers have watched me grow more intimitely then anyone. I am not relegious, in fact my spiritual compass points from Pi Singh to Jimmy Page, but my family's Mary speaks to me. She speaks to me of faith, of doubt, of changing, of leaving, of returning home.

editor's note

Recently, I went to a book club meeting where a rather interesting question was asked- what in your home makes you connect to art. There were some quite interesting responses- terraces and windows, and straight up an entire river running behind someone's house. I didn't raise my hand to answer, but I knew exactly what artwork defined my house, or houses if you must. My family owns a 2 feet porcelein statue of the Virgin Mary. She's wearing simple robes of white and light blue. Her fair face has the graceful expression of faith and with a tiny rosary dangling from her delicate hands joined in prayer. The Mother is garlanded by another real rosary, curtsey my own mother. I was raised in a fairly Catholic house. I've been lapsed for a few years, but I can still recite *Hail Holy Queen*. I had looked at the statue every single day before school. Morning prayer. *Dear God, keep me well, keep my parents well, keep my friends well, keep my studies well. Amen.* This was the first prayer I came up with when praying became coherent to a child, and stayed till it was murmerd hurriedly and morning prayer was reduced a cursory, skeptical glance to the Divine Virgin. We lost her for a year, when my family shifted cities, and she was deemed to fragile to survive the ardous journey across the country. Mary spent a year alone in the empty house, then on a visit to the hometown, my mother swaddled Mother Mary in a large clean towel, and craddled her in her arms like a newborn baby across a 24-hour train journey. The Divine Virgin entered another house and assumed her place at the topmost shelf of a glass cabinet, overlooking a balcony overpopulated by potted plants and squirrels and sparrows. My mother recieved it from her father when she entered a new home after her

JUKEBOX

THE 90S JILTED LOVER

FOR WHEN YOU MADE UP TOO MANY SCENARIOS IN YOUR HEAD

-*curated by* frand

1. ***That's Why You Go Away*, Mikey Learns To Rock**
2. ***Lost in the Woods*, Jonathan Groff**
3. ***Total Eclipse of the Heart*, Bonnie Tyler**
4. ***Nothing Compares 2 U*, Sinéad O'Connor**
5. ***The Reason*, Hoobastank**
6. ***Torn*, Natalie Imbruglia**
7. ***Nothong's Gonna Change My Love for You*, George Benson**

CURATOR'S NOTES

All of these have to be performed dramatically on full volume, alone in ones room. *Backed by the editor of the Weakly*